

Old For(r)est Consulting

EST. UTAH · MANAGED INTELLIGENCE

FOR TRADES · FACTORIES · FRANCHISES

Operational clarity for businesses that run on *more than software.*

We configure the systems, connect the data, build what's missing,
and stay on-call when it breaks. One partner instead of seven.

PITCH DOCUMENT · 2026

PREPARED FOR PROSPECTIVE CLIENTS

CHRIS@OLDFORREST.NET
OLDFORREST.NET

THE SHORT VERSION

One firm that integrates, embeds, maintains, and builds the stack your business actually runs on — and handles your vendors.

Most mid-market operations-heavy businesses run on a dozen tools nobody fully understands: a CRM, a field app, a time tracker, a quoting tool, an ERP module, a couple of spreadsheets holding everything together, and a few pieces of hardware in the shop that one person knows how to fix. When something breaks, you call a different vendor for each layer. When you want to know how the business is actually doing, you get a report that's two weeks old.

We replace that. We're a small firm that does what used to take a fractional CTO, an MSP, a BI consultancy, and an integration partner — combined, coordinated, and delivered by the same team that knows your business. AI-enabled where it matters; human where it has to be.

THE FOUR VERBS

Integrate

Make your systems talk. CRM to accounting to field tools to dashboards. No more data trapped in silos.

Embed

Configure the stack to how your business actually works. Not theoretical best-practice — your reality.

Maintain

On-call for the software and hardware. Monitoring, updates, fixes. Your stack stays quiet.

Build

Custom dashboards, automations, tools. When off-the-shelf doesn't fit your workflow, we ship what does.

Plus the quiet killer feature: **we handle your vendors.**

One throat to choke. We own the relationship with your CRM provider, your field-tool vendor, your hardware supplier, your internet provider, and the guy who built your website. You stop being the integration manager for your own business.

THREE VERTICALS, ONE PATTERN

Operations-heavy businesses the big firms won't touch and the generalists don't understand.

Every business we serve shares the same profile: physical operations, a distributed workforce or locations, a mix of legacy and modern tools, data trapped across systems, and no one on the inside whose job is to make sense of it. The BI consultancies won't touch them because the engagements are too small. Generalist MSPs don't understand how the business actually runs. We sit in that gap — and we're the only people who belong there.

TRADES

Construction, exteriors, roofing, HVAC, plumbing, electrical. Field crews, job sites, multiple entities, quoting and scheduling tools layered over accounting, and a CRM that nobody trusts.

FACTORIES

Small-to-mid manufacturers, shops, fabrication. ERP modules, shop-floor hardware, inventory and production data that doesn't reach management in time to act on it.

FRANCHISES

Multi-location operators. Each location runs a slightly different stack, corporate wants unified reporting, and "rolling it up" currently means someone's spreadsheet.

WHY WE WORK FOR THESE BUSINESSES

1

We're the whole stack.

You stop paying four different vendors to coordinate badly. One invoice, one Slack channel, one partner who knows everything.

2

We move fast because we use AI where it matters.

Configuration, integration, and dashboard work that took agencies three months takes us three weeks. You get agency-grade output at a pace that actually matches how your business moves.

3

We stay.

After the initial build, we're still here — monitoring, iterating, answering the phone when the shop PC won't boot. Most consultants hand off and disappear. We don't.

4

We know your business, not just your software.

A dashboard is only useful if the person who built it understands what the numbers mean to you. We take the time to get that right once, and everything downstream is better for it.

HOW IT WORKS

The Embed sprint: when you want it all configured in 90 days.

The flow below is what an **Embed** engagement looks like — a 90-day configuration sprint that takes a business from tool sprawl to a working, integrated stack with live dashboards and documented runbooks. It's the right fit when you want real change fast. Clients who already have a working stack can skip the sprint and start at **Operate** or **Maintain** — the first 30 days of any engagement still include discovery, just proportional to the tier.

PHASE 01**Weeks 1–2****Discovery**

- Inventory every tool, vendor, and integration
- Walk the shop, ride along with field crews
- Interview owners, ops leads, and daily users
- Map data flows — real ones, not org-chart ones
- Identify quick wins and deep fixes

PHASE 02**Weeks 3–6****Configure**

- Stand up and tune CRM, field tools, accounting links
- Build workflows and automations
- Fix or replace broken vendor setups
- Standardize data entry and naming
- Document everything as we go

PHASE 03**Weeks 7–10****Integrate & Build**

- Connect systems to central data layer
- Build live BI dashboards (owner, ops, field)
- Custom tooling where off-the-shelf falls short
- Alerting on what actually matters
- Vendor relationships formalized under us

PHASE 04**Weeks 11–12****Handoff & Steady State**

- Train your team on the new flow
- Document the full stack and runbooks
- Transition to ongoing support tier
- Set recurring review cadence
- On-call coverage begins

After the 90 days, what steady state looks like

You have a stack that works. Your dashboards are live. Your vendors are managed. Your data tells you what happened yesterday, not what happened last month. When something breaks, you call one number. When you want to change something, you ask one team.

We're still here — as much or as little as you need. Most clients settle into a monthly rhythm of a standing review, ongoing small builds, and on-call coverage for the stack. Some need more. Some need less. The tier structure on the next page is how we match what you need to what you pay.

TRANSPARENT BY DESIGN

Four tiers. Pick the right entry point for where you are today.

Pick the tier that matches where you are today. Most clients with real operational complexity start with **Embed** — a 90-day configuration sprint that gets the whole stack into shape fast. Others start at **Operate** or **Maintain** and build momentum from there. **Build** projects sit alongside any tier for discrete work.

FLAGSHIP ENGAGEMENT

Embed

90-DAY INTENSIVE

\$40k/mo

× 3 months · \$120k total

- Full discovery and inventory
- Stack configuration and tuning
- System integration and data layer
- BI dashboards built and live
- Custom tooling as needed
- Vendor consolidation
- Documentation and runbooks
- Handoff to steady-state tier

Operate

ACTIVE ONGOING

\$10k–\$15k/mo

Multi-system, active work

- Everything in Maintain, plus:
- Ongoing dashboard iteration
- Active vendor management
- New integrations as needed
- Monthly strategy review
- Custom builds included up to scope

Maintain

STABILIZED · LOW-TOUCH

\$5k/mo

~20 hours/mo

- On-call software & hardware support
- Integration monitoring
- Minor iterations and fixes
- Monthly review and roadmap check-in
- Vendor liaison
- Larger work scoped as Build projects

BUILD · DISCRETE PROJECTS

Layered on any tier when you need a specific thing built — a new integration, a custom tool, a migration, a website rebuild. **Fixed-fee scopes, not hourly.** Most projects land in the \$5k–\$50k range depending on complexity.

THREE WAYS TO START

Embed is the right fit when you want everything configured, integrated, and live in 90 days — multi-entity holdings, multi-location operators, or trades companies that have outgrown the spreadsheet stage. **Operate** makes sense when you already have a working stack and want us actively building, integrating, and iterating alongside your team. **Maintain** is for businesses whose stack is stable and who mostly need a reliable on-call partner and a monthly check-in. Any tier can

WHAT YOU'D PAY ELSEWHERE

The split-vendor comparison.

The easiest way to understand what Embed is worth is to price out what it costs to source the same work across the vendors you'd otherwise hire. Here's the current-market comparison for a client with real operational complexity — the kind of client who needs Embed.

FUNCTION	TYPICAL VENDOR	MONTHLY EQUIVALENT
HubSpot / CRM admin & RevOps	Certified partner agency	\$8k–\$15k ¹
Custom BI dashboards & hosting	Dev shop or freelance team	\$10k–\$20k ²
Fractional CTO	Solo fractional	\$10k–\$15k ³
Fractional COO / ops strategist	Solo fractional	\$8k–\$12k ⁴
Managed IT / on-call support	Regional MSP	\$3k–\$6k ⁵
Web dev / integrations	Agency project fees, amortized	\$5k–\$10k ⁶
Vendor evaluation & procurement	Boutique consultant	\$5k–\$10k ⁷
Executive documentation & comms	Fractional chief of staff	\$3k–\$5k ⁸
Split-vendor total (midpoint)		~\$70k/mo

Embed is ~40% less than the split-vendor equivalent.

Embed at \$40k/mo is roughly 40% below the midpoint of sourcing the same work across vendors — before counting the coordination tax (20–30% slippage across 6–8 vendors) and the project-management burden that currently falls on you. In steady state, Maintain at \$5k/mo is the cheapest insurance policy you'll buy for your stack.

WHAT MAKES THIS MATH WORK

- **AI where it matters.** Configuration, documentation, and dashboard work is force-multiplied by modern tooling. Agency-grade output at two-person speed.
- **Vertical pattern recognition.** We've done this in construction and exteriors already. We're not learning your industry on your dime.
- **Context compounds.** After 90 days we know your business. A vendor you replaced starts from zero; we build on

METHODOLOGY & REFERENCES

Where the comparison numbers come from.

The split-vendor comparison uses 2026 market-rate ranges drawn from published pricing guides, benchmark reports, and MSP/fractional-leadership research across North America. Ranges reflect what a mid-market operationally-complex client would pay to source each function from a qualified specialist. Source numbers match the superscripts in the comparison table.

1 HubSpot / CRM admin & RevOps — \$8k–\$15k/mo

Certified HubSpot partner agency retainers for active portal administration, RevOps architecture, and workflow management. Range consistent with industry-standard implementation-plus-retainer pricing for mid-market HubSpot customers.
HubSpot Solutions Partner directory pricing benchmarks, 2026. Blended from certified partner public rate cards.

2 Custom BI dashboards & hosting — \$10k–\$20k/mo

Ongoing dev-shop or freelance-team retainers for custom BI builds (Next.js, React, data pipeline, hosting). Reflects typical full-stack team rates for active dashboard iteration plus infrastructure management.
US dev agency retainer benchmarks, 2026; cross-referenced with Pertama Partners AI/BI implementation cost ranges.

3 Fractional CTO — \$10k–\$15k/mo

Mid-to-upper range for ongoing fractional CTO retainers for growth-stage and mid-market companies, reflecting 2–3 days per week of senior technical leadership.
Fractional CTO Cost & Rates 2026 Complete Pricing Guide (fractionaltoexperts.com); Kompella Technologies 2026 pricing guide; Emizentech fractional CTO rates 2026.

4 Fractional COO / ops strategist — \$8k–\$12k/mo

Typical ongoing retainer range for solo fractional COO/ops leadership at mid-market scale. Aligned with fractional-executive ranges across adjacent functions (CFO, CTO) in operations-heavy industries.
Cross-referenced from Madras Accountancy Fractional CFO Rates by Industry 2026 (construction vertical) and fractional-executive pricing guides.

5 Managed IT / on-call support — \$3k–\$6k/mo

Regional MSP pricing for a ~20–30 user mid-market trades/construction client at \$100–\$200 per user per month for comprehensive managed services including monitoring, helpdesk, and security.
Datapath Managed IT Services Pricing Guide 2026; Solutionbuilders Ultimate 2026 Guide to Managed IT Services Pricing; Corsica Technologies 2026 pricing benchmarks.

6 Web dev / integrations — \$5k–\$10k/mo

Amortized agency project fees for website rebuilds, integration builds, and ongoing web development work, spread over typical 6–12 month engagement cycles.
US digital agency project-fee benchmarks, 2026. Derived from public agency rate cards for mid-market clients.

7 Vendor evaluation & procurement — \$5k–\$10k/mo

Boutique consulting fees for ongoing vendor evaluation, procurement support, and tool selection across software and hardware stacks typical in operationally-complex mid-market businesses.
Boutique consulting retainer benchmarks; cross-referenced from MSP value-based pricing examples in DeskDay 2026 MSP pricing guide.

8 Executive documentation & comms — \$3k–\$5k/mo

Fractional chief of staff or executive-ghostwriter monthly retainer range for ongoing leadership documentation, briefings, and stakeholder communications at mid-market scale.
Fractional chief-of-staff market benchmarks, 2026.

Coordination tax estimate (20–30% additional cost across 6–8 vendors) reflects commonly-reported overhead from duplicated discovery, misaligned context, and client-side project management burden when sourcing across multiple specialized vendors. Client savings will vary by stack complexity, vendor count, and operational maturity.

CASE STUDY

ERK Holdings — a multi-entity construction & exteriors family of companies.

CLIENT: ERK
HOLDINGS**ENTITIES:** 4+
OPERATING
COMPANIES**ENGAGEMENT:**
ONGOING (12+
MONTHS)**INDUSTRIES:** CONSTRUCTION ·
ROOFING · EXTERIORS

THE SITUATION

A Utah-based holding company with several operating businesses across construction, roofing, and exterior services. Multiple CRMs, field tools, time-tracking, and accounting platforms — none talking to each other. Ownership couldn't get a clear picture across entities. Vendor sprawl was real: a marketing agency, a website provider, a CRM partner, and several software tools with no unified owner.

WHAT WE DID

- Rebuilt the HubSpot portal — pipelines, deal stages, properties, associations across entities
- Configured forms, workflows, and auto-reply automations for Cardinal Roofing's inbound demand
- Built a live pipeline health dashboard in Next.js, deployed to a dedicated VPS
- Evaluated and selected workforce tools (time tracking, GPS fleet) with written comparison briefs
- Handled the Orem office's internet infrastructure decision (UTOPIA Fiber)
- Rebuilt Cardinal Roofing's website, coordinating the transition off the prior agency
- Active on-call coverage for software and hardware issues across entities

THE OUTCOME

ERK's ownership now has cross-entity visibility they couldn't get before. Each operating company has a CRM pipeline that's actually trusted. Vendor count is down; coordination overhead is near zero. The firm operates as fractional operational leadership across the holding — in-office regularly, available to leadership, with active expansion into additional entities.

4+OPERATING
ENTITIES
SUPPORTED**12+**MONTHS
ACTIVE
ENGAGEMENT**1**PARTNER
REPLACING
A FLEET OF
VENDORS**~40%**BELOW SPLIT-
VENDOR
COST EQUIVALENT

HOW THE FIRST CONVERSATION WORKS

No pressure. No long sales cycle. We'll tell you honestly if we're a fit.

We don't do the traditional enterprise sales dance. If you're a trades, factory, or franchise operation that's felt the pain of too many disconnected tools, the first conversation is simple.

1 Intro call — 30 minutes.

Tell us about your business, the stack, and what's frustrating you right now. No slides, no pitch. We listen.

2 Discovery session — 60–90 minutes.

If there's a fit, we do a paid working session walking the stack together. You come away with a clear picture of what an engagement looks like.

3 Scoped proposal — within 5 business days.

The right tier for you — Embed, Operate, or Maintain — with a realistic scope and a fixed price. No surprises.

4 Decide on your timeline.

Yes, and we start when you're ready. No or not-yet, and we part cleanly. Either way you leave with a clearer picture of your own stack.

Let's have the first conversation.

Reach out directly. Mention who referred you — it goes to the top of the queue.

Email	chris@oldforrest.net
Partner	taylor@oldforrest.net
Web	oldforrest.net

WHO WE ARE

Old Forrest Consulting is a Utah-based firm founded by **Christopher Ledbetter** and **Taylor Westmoreland**. Christopher's background spans technical leadership at NetApp, Dropbox, and Orbital ATK. Taylor is an aerospace engineer turned operator. We built Old Forrest to be the kind of partner we wished we'd had when we were on the operating side — honest, fast, and present.